Fat-Loss Meal Plan: Tamil and Kerala Non-Veg

36 M, 5'10", 77 kg to 70 kg | Software Engineer, weekend sports

Note: The original template said "strictly vegetarian" but the dietary preference was Tamil and Kerala non-veg. This plan follows the non-veg preference, with fish, egg and chicken as the main proteins.

1. Calorie & Macro Targets

These are estimates (Mifflin-St Jeor, BMR about 1,710 kcal). Weigh yourself weekly and adjust by about 100 kcal if the scale doesn't move for 2 to 3 weeks.

	Non-Workout Day (desk job)	Workout Day (weekend sports)
Estimated TDEE	~2,050 kcal	~2,650 kcal
Target intake	**~1,600 kcal**	**~2,100 kcal**
Deficit	~450 kcal	~550 kcal
Protein	~120 g (1.6 g/kg)	~135 g
Carbs	~160 g	~240 g
Fat	~53 g	~67 g
Fibre	30 g+	35 g+

Weekly average is about 1,730 kcal against a TDEE of about 2,220, a deficit of roughly 490 kcal per day. That should give about 0.4 to 0.5 kg loss per week, so 7 kg takes about 14 to 16 weeks.

Any day can be a workout day. Just use that column on the days you train.

2. 7-Day Meal Plan

Use 1 tsp oil per dish, and cook fish and chicken by curry, roast or grill rather than deep fry. Rice is cooked weight, preferably matta, red or brown. Chapatis are small (about 40 g dough each).

Day	Meal	Dish & Portion (Workout Day)	Dish & Portion (Non-Workout Day)
Mon	**Breakfast**	3 idli + 1 cup sambar + 2 boiled eggs	2 idli + ¾ cup sambar + 1 boiled egg
	Lunch	1¼ cup rice + meen kuzhambu (150 g fish) + ½ cup keerai poriyal + ½ cup curd	¾ cup rice + meen kuzhambu (100 g fish) + ½ cup keerai poriyal + ½ cup curd
	Snack	1 cup kondakadalai sundal + 1 glass buttermilk + 1 banana	1 glass buttermilk + 30 g roasted chana
	Dinner	2 chapati + 150 g pepper chicken + cucumber-onion salad	2 chapati + 100 g pepper chicken + cucumber-onion salad
Tue	**Breakfast**	2 ragi dosa + coconut-pudina chutney (2 tbsp) + 2-egg omelette	1 ragi dosa + chutney + 2-egg omelette
	Lunch	1¼ cup rice + chicken chettinad (150 g, light gravy) + ¾ cup beans poriyal + rasam	¾ cup rice + chicken chettinad (100 g) + ¾ cup beans poriyal + rasam
	Snack	Ragi malt (1 glass, no sugar, jaggery ½ tsp) + 6 almonds	1 glass buttermilk + 1 sprouted moong salad (½ cup)
	Dinner	3 idli + 1 cup sambar + 1 boiled egg	2 idli + ¾ cup sambar + 1 boiled egg
Wed	**Breakfast**	Vegetable oats upma (1½ cup) + 2 boiled eggs	Vegetable oats upma (1 cup) + 1 boiled egg
	Lunch	1¼ cup rice + Kerala fish curry (150 g, kudampuli style) + cabbage thoran (¾ cup)	¾ cup rice + Kerala fish curry (100 g) + cabbage thoran (¾ cup)
	Snack	Boiled sweet potato (150 g) + buttermilk	Cucumber + guava slices + buttermilk
	Dinner	2 wheat dosa + 1 cup chicken stew (Kerala style, light coconut milk)	2 wheat dosa + ¾ cup chicken stew
Thu	**Breakfast**	2 pesarattu (green moong dosa) + ginger chutney + 2 boiled eggs	2 pesarattu + ginger chutney + 1 boiled egg
	Lunch	1¼ cup rice + mutton kari (100 g lean, 1 cup) + keerai masiyal (¾ cup) + curd (½ cup)	¾ cup rice + egg curry (2 eggs) + keerai masiyal (¾ cup) + curd (½ cup)
	Snack	Sundal (peanut + coconut, 1 cup) + buttermilk	1 apple + 6 almonds
	Dinner	2 chapati + dal tadka/kootu (1 cup) + 2-egg bhurji	2 chapati + dal kootu (1 cup)
Fri	**Breakfast**	3 idli + milagai podi (1 tsp with ½ tsp gingelly oil) + sambar (1 cup) + 1 boiled egg	2 idli + sambar (¾ cup) + 1 boiled egg
	Lunch	1¼ cup rice + sardine (mathi) fry (pan-roasted, 2 medium) + sambar (½ cup) + avial (¾ cup)	¾ cup rice + sardine fry (2 medium) + sambar (½ cup) + avial (¾ cup)
	Snack	Ragi malt + 1 banana	Buttermilk + roasted chana (30 g)
	Dinner	2 chapati + chicken sukka (150 g) + salad	2 chapati + chicken sukka (100 g) + salad
Sat	**Breakfast**	2 ragi idiyappam + vegetable kurma (1 cup) + 2-egg omelette	2 idiyappam + vegetable kurma (¾ cup) + 1 boiled egg
	Lunch	1½ cup rice + prawn masala (150 g) + poriyal (¾ cup) + rasam	¾ cup rice + prawn masala (100 g) + poriyal (¾ cup) + rasam
	Snack	Pre-sports: banana + 8 soaked almonds. Post: buttermilk + sundal (1 cup)	Buttermilk + cucumber
	Dinner	2 chapati + chicken kurma (150 g, light) + curd (½ cup)	2 chapati + dal + salad
Sun	**Breakfast**	Kerala puttu (1 cup) + kadala curry (¾ cup) + 2 boiled eggs	Puttu (¾ cup) + kadala curry (½ cup) + 1 boiled egg
	Lunch	1½ cup rice + chicken biryalone-style light curry or meen kuzhambu (150 g) + 1 cup poriyal + curd	¾ cup rice + fish curry (100 g) + 1 cup poriyal + curd
	Snack	Roasted peanut-jaggery chikki (1 small) + coconut water	Coconut water + guava

Day	Meal	Dish & Portion (Workout Day)	Dish & Portion (Non-Workout Day)
	Dinner	3 idli + sambar (1 cup) + 1-egg podimas	2 idli + sambar (¾ cup) + 1 boiled egg

Swap any fish dish for another lean fish (seer, tilapia, pomfret, mackerel). Mackerel and sardines are good for omega-3. Keep mutton to once a week.

3. Desk-Job & Busy Schedule Survival Tips

- **Hydration:** Aim for 3 to 3.5 L on workout days and 2.5 to 3 L on desk days. Keep a 1 L bottle on your desk and finish it twice. Buttermilk, lemon-pudina water or tender coconut water count toward this.
- **Snack drawer:** Keep roasted chana, peanuts (a small handful, about 20 g), and fruit at your desk. This stops you reaching for office biscuits or samosas.
- **Batch prep on Sunday:** Make the chutney and podi, boil and sprout moong, and marinate chicken and fish in portions. Weekday cooking then takes about 20 minutes.
- **Eat protein first:** Have the fish, egg or chicken before the rice. This keeps you full through afternoon meetings.
- **Tea and coffee:** Limit to 2 cups a day with minimal sugar (1 tsp or less).
- **Move every 60 to 90 minutes:** Take a 3 to 5 minute walk or stretch, and aim for 7,000 to 8,000 steps on desk days.
- **Eating out:** Choose idli, dosa, grilled or tandoor items, or meen kuzhambu meals with rice limited to 1 cup. Skip parotta, fried rice and fried chicken.
- **Sleep:** Aim for 7 hours or more. Poor sleep raises hunger hormones and makes the deficit harder to stick to.
- **Flexibility:** If you miss a planned workout, switch to the Non-Workout column for that day. Never eat below about 1,500 kcal.

This is general guidance, not personalised medical advice. If you have any health conditions, check with your doctor or a dietitian before starting.